Assignment 04: Meeting room booking with Spring Data JPA Basic

Build a persistent Meeting Room Booking web application that replaces the in-memory storage of Assignment 03 with Spring Data JPA and MySQL.

This assignment follows Lecture Chapter 06 (Spring Data JPA Basic) and Lab 3 (Spring Data JPA Basic).

In Assignment 03, you built a Meeting Room Booking app with @Controller, Thymeleaf, validation and business rules but stored bookings in an in-memory ArrayList (causing data loss whenever the server restarted).

Here, in this assignment you will connect your application to a relational database using Spring Data JPA. The presentation layer (BookingController, BookingRequest and Thymeleaf templates) should remain virtually unchanged, proving the power of a clean layered architecture.

Implement your work as a Spring Boot Maven project using Java 26+ with Spring Web, Thymeleaf, Validation, Spring Data JPA and MySQL Connector.

Organize your code into model, dto, repository, service and controller.

All business logic rules from Assignment 03 must remain fully enforced.

Notes

1. Submit the complete Spring Boot project, runnable with command: mvn spring-boot:run
2. Persistence verification: stop the Spring Boot application, restart it and refresh http://localhost:8080/bookings showing that all previously created bookings remain intact without data loss.
3. Screenshots must be provided to demonstrate that all the requirements (including validation from assignment 03) are met.